

Google Wallet again?

With the speculations of taking the ownership of SoftCard, Google Wallet might be coming back strong owing to the success of Apple Pay <http://dgit.in/GoogWall>



New Lumias

Microsoft recently launched two new budget offerings - the Lumia 532 and the Lumia 435 at Rs.6499 and Rs.5999 respectively. <http://dgit.in/BudLumia>

TP-Link Archer C7 AC1750 Wireless Router

Affordable AC1750 solution with a little room for improvement

The TP-Link Archer C7 isn't a new router, in fact the current model would be a revision 3 SKU that only sells in one country and has six external antennae whereas this here is the v1.1 SKU which also has six antennae of which three are internal. There are plenty of AC1750 routers in the market these days and the prices have dropped tremendously in the last year and a half. The C7 has the QCA9880 at its heart which are connected to the 5dBi external antennae while the QCA9558 which handles the N radio is connected to the

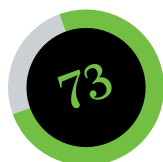


Price
₹14,999

internal antennae. This arrangement gives you the flexibility of adjusting the antennae for the radio although we'd have preferred six antennae like the v3 SKU. After all this is one of the premium routers that TP-Link has to offer.

Speaking of the firmware, we noticed that easy to configure QoS settings were missing but you can add rules under the Bandwidth Control tab to somewhat make up for it. You don't get to choose the priority of a certain kind of traffic but ingress and egress bandwidth from an IP range across a set of ports can be ensured/limited. Or you could simply flash open-wrt but that will make your 5GHz radio to cease functioning and getting that to work is a daunting task. If you want control over antennae orientation then go for the Archer C7 but if you want QoS then there is the similarly priced D-Link 868L for you.

Mithun Mobandas



Performance.....76
Features.....68
Build Quality.....75

Specifications

Wireless LAN Chip: QCA9880+QCA9558; **Memory:** 128 MB; **Protocols:** 802.11 b/g/n/ac; **Bandwidth:** 1750(1300@5GHz +450@2.4GHz) Mbps; **Ethernet:** 4x LAN, 1x WAN, GbE Ports, Without modem; **Warranty:** 3 years.

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Cowon EK2

More bang for buck

The 1k or sub 1k price range for in-ear headphones is perhaps the most busy segment, at least in terms of volume. This is where the numbers are, and therefore, this is where manufacturers have and will continue to devote their attention for the foreseeable future. The subject of this review is Cowon's EK2 - an in-ear headphone that might just cannibalise Cowon's own EM1 SKU. If you guys remember the EM1 has been our most recommended budget IEM for a while, so comparisons with the EM1 will be aplenty in this review.

There are a lot of similarities between the two - the specifications, the flat cable and of course the price range. Do they sound different though? Saying they're differently tuned would be stating the obvious. But how different are the EK2s from the EM1s? Not a lot.

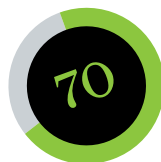


Price
₹1,100

The better quality tips for one provide a better fit and seal. In terms of performance, the EK2 is tuned towards giving you more detail in the higher frequency ranges. In this effort it loses out on some of the body or "fullness" that a well represented mid-range imparts to most forms of music. The EM1 therefore feels more rich but at the same time a shade less precise. If any of you have had the chance to demo the EM1 and found them to be lacking on the bass front, you'll find the EK2s severely lacking - they're not, it's just that true-to-source bass representation often seems below par to most people. Another important distinction between the EK2 and EM1 is that the EK2 seem to be a little more sensitive, so more volume per input of input power.

Nostalgia aside the EM1s still give you bang for your buck if you're on a really tight budget. However, if you have a little more money to spare (only about 150 bucks more), the EK2s will provide a near-proportionate boost in incremental value. They're a worthy purchase just as the EM1 has been.

Siddharth Parwatay



Features.....70
Performance.....70
Value.....68
Build quality.....67

Specifications

Driver size: 10mm; **Impedance:** 16 ohms; **Rated power:** 3mW; **Max power:** 20mW; **Sensitivity:** 103dB (at1mW); **Frequency range:** 20HZ to 22,000Hz; **Cord length:** 1.2m

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